

Let's consider an objection to the second premise of Descartes' argument:

2. If I can clearly imagine something being the case, then
it is possible for it to be the case.

Here is a possible counterexample to this premise:

Can you clearly imagine this small town? Is it possible for there to be a town of this sort?

The barber

Deep in the Indiana countryside, there's a small town; and in this town there's a barber. Some of the men in this small town - the industrious ones - shave themselves every morning. But others (the lazy ones) don't; and the barber shaves all of them. (There's no one else around who will do it.) Moreover, he (the barber's a man) never shaves any of the industrious ones - he never shaves any of the men that shave themselves.



it is possible for it to be the case.

2. If I can clearly imagine something being the case, then

Can you clearly imagine this in a town? Is it possible for there to be a town of this

sort?

The barber

Deep in the Indiana countryside, there's a small town; and in this town there's a barber. Some of the men in this small town - the industrious ones - shave themselves every morning. But others (the lazy ones) don't; and the barber shaves all of them. (There's no one else around who will do it.) Moreover, he (the barber's a man) never shaves any of the industrious ones - he never shaves any of the men that shave themselves.